considers migration to be the norm while the rarely-travelled nativist sees it as an aberration. Gandhi added a third dimension, that of the cosmopolitan recommending fixity. These three views summarize the range of views towards migration across the world and they are intrinsically linked with the process of ‘development’ or the general rise in living standards. For the question each is asking is: *whose* living standards are being raised by migration?

Migration in Five Transitions

‘Development’, used here as a term to reflect rising per capita incomes and human capital in education and health, has been associated with the scientific, political, economic, urban and demographic revolutions or transitions of the modern world. The scientific revolution led to the creation of technologies that transformed the scale of production, transportation and communication. The political transition refers to the transition from autocracy to democracy, often via the status of being a colonizing or colonized state. The economic transition manifested itself in the dramatic diversification of economic activity away from agriculture—in capitalist, socialist and communist systems. Economic development was also closely linked with urbanization or a spatial shift away from villages to cities as the global share of population living in urban areas crossed 50 per cent in the first decade of the 21st century. Finally, every society underwent, or is undergoing, the demographic transition from high death and birth rates to low death and birth rates.

It was once thought that a similar ‘mobility transition’ accompanied this process of development, from low rates to high rates and from nomadic to settler and finally circulatory streams of migration.[4] Careful historical research has shown that mobility rates in the Eurasian world before 1800 CE were not as low as was previously thought and that mobility rates fell from the highs of the late 19th and early 20th century in many ‘developed’ societies.[5] Circular migration for work and military migration have also been documented as a major driving force of migration in those societies in